

SOP-LV-028 — Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation

Recognizing, De-escalating, and Reporting Hostile or Disruptive Encounters

SOP NUMBER	SOP-LV-028
TITLE	Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation
EFFECTIVE DATE	July 25, 2026
REVISION	1.0
APPLIES TO	All Apex field technicians — Ontario & Manitoba
CATEGORY	Personal Safety & Conduct

1. Purpose

This procedure gives Apex technicians a clear, practiced response for recognizing, de-escalating, and reporting encounters with hostile, aggressive, or disruptive individuals on a jobsite. It was developed in direct response to a real incident involving a disruptive tenant encountered during a security camera installation, and is intended to give every technician a script to fall back on rather than having to improvise in the moment.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all Apex technicians on every jobsite type — commercial, institutional, residential, and public-facing sites — in Ontario and Manitoba. It applies whether the technician is working alone (see SOP-LV-029, Lone Worker Safety) or as part of a crew.

3. Definitions

- Workplace Violence — the exercise of physical force, or an attempt or threat to exercise physical force, against a worker that could cause physical injury.
- Workplace Harassment — a course of vexatious comment or conduct that is known, or ought reasonably to be known, to be unwelcome.
- De-escalation — techniques used to reduce the intensity of a conflict or potentially violent situation before it escalates further.

4. Recognizing Warning Signs

- Raised voice, aggressive posture, or invading personal space.
- Refusing to leave the immediate work area after being asked.
- Direct or implied threats, or blocking an exit or path of travel.
- Visible signs of impairment combined with escalating behaviour.

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5. De-escalation Basics

- Stay calm — keep your voice low and even, even if the other person is not.
- Keep distance and always maintain a clear path to an exit; never let yourself get boxed in.
- Do not argue, correct, or try to “win” the interaction. Use neutral, non-confrontational language.
- If the person will not calm down, disengage — tell them plainly you are stepping away, and do so.

6. When to Disengage and Call for Help

If there is any threat of physical harm, a weapon is present, or the person will not stop after a clear warning — leave the area immediately and call 911.

Do not attempt to reason further or wait to see if the situation improves. Your safety comes first, every time.

Once you are safe, call your supervisor. If the situation was serious enough to involve police, call your supervisor as soon as it is safe to do so, even if police are already on their way.

7. Reporting Requirement

Any encounter involving aggression, threats, or disruptive behaviour must be reported to your supervisor the same day and documented using the Apex Incident Report process — even if it was verbal-only and no one was hurt. Under the Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, Apex is required to investigate every workplace violence report; a report you consider minor may reveal a pattern only visible once documented.

8. Returning to a Site After an Incident

Do not return alone to a site where a threat occurred without first clearing it with your supervisor. Apex will coordinate with the client or property manager on next steps — additional site contact, a different point of access, or a second technician — before work resumes there.

9. Prohibited Practices

- Never escalate verbally — do not argue, mock, or match aggression with aggression.
- Never physically restrain another person except in immediate self-defence where there is no other option.
- Never keep an incident to yourself because it “wasn’t a big deal” — report it regardless of severity.

10. Regulatory References

- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, ss. 32.0.1–32.0.7 — Workplace Violence and Workplace Harassment
- Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, C.C.S.M. c. W210 — Workplace Harassment and Violence provisions
- Criminal Code of Canada — general self-defence provisions (reference only; consult legal counsel for specifics)

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11. Related Apex Documents

- SOP-LV-029 — Lone Worker Safety
- SOP-LV-030 — Occupied-Space Conduct Policy
- Apex Incident Report Process

12. Revision History

Rev.	Date	Description	Approved By
1.0	Jul 25, 2026	Initial release	P. Cimini

This document is proprietary to Apex and is intended for internal use by Apex technicians and supervisors. Effective date: July 25, 2026.